

« Rallying has always been the pioneer of motorsport in India »

GAURAV GILL

Kavita Menon

kavita.menon@thehindu.co.in

Gaurav Gill has carved an extraordinary path on the dusty, winding stages of rallying. During a nearly two-decade-long journey, he has led the charge in a sport that struggles to gain mainstream recognition in India.

The 43-year-old is a multiple Indian National Rally Championship (INRC) winner and an icon on Indian terrain. Gill is the first Indian to win the FIA Asia-Pacific Rally Championship (APRC). He clinched the coveted crown as early as 2013, before adding two more to his cabinet in 2016 and 2018.

India's first Arjuna Awardee in motorsport (2019), he made a foray into the World Rally Championship-2 (WRC2) — the support championship of WRC — in 2018. After a few stints that saw near-misses but positive takeaways, Gill is now ready for another go at it, with his eye on the elusive podium.

Racing with JK Tyres in 2025, he is scheduled to participate in a few rounds of WRC2 this season, starting from June 26-29 in Greece. However, alongside international action, he will also be participating in the INRC.

In an interview with *Sportstar*, Gill discusses his journey and the challenges in the Indian motorsport ecosystem.

You've achieved what many Indian rally racers dream of — competing in the WRC2. How did that opportunity come about, and what

did it mean to you personally?

The World Rally Championship is the biggest platform for anyone to go and compete. For us, coming from India, it's very difficult to raise a lot of sponsorship. I'm fortunate that I have partners and sponsors like JK Tyres (and previously MRF Tyres) and others who support me.

We've had a small break for a year as we wanted to concentrate on the Indian National Rally Championship as well, because that's an important market for the manufacturers. We are also looking at international



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